SHAME-03 | Therapist only - all age groups

A respectful inner response

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Choose inner language that acknowledges difficulty and relevant responsibility without self-humiliation. The outcome is a brief, believable response or supportive action, not a positive slogan one must believe.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not deny harm, demand self-forgiveness, or use a phrase to cancel a feeling. Do not repeat ritualistically until feeling okay. If an internal exercise increases distress or disconnection, stop and assess suitability with a professional.

Reusing existing material

SHAME-02 distinguishes messages from context. Here, choose a respectful response; SELF-04 can help address criticism without turning discussion into proof of self-worth.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: After a mistake, Uri usually calls himself worthless. He chooses to say that he made a mistake in a particular action and can explore what is needed now, even if shame remains.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What inner wording adds suffering to the situation?

2 | Question for discussion

What actual responsibility should be preserved in the response?

3 | Question for discussion

How will I acknowledge difficulty without making it a verdict on me?

4 | Question for discussion

What wording fits my language and values?

5 | Question for discussion

What practical response could support me alongside words?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If a phrase feels unbelievable, simplify it or choose listening and action. If it becomes a demand for repeated reassurance, explore that instead of increasing repetitions.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

An adult offers simple language and models respect. The child need not say a positive phrase or show emotional improvement to receive listening.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Allow personal wording that does not sound like an adult's slogan. Do not require sharing the phrase or recording private responses.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Make room for the participant's language and values. Acknowledging responsibility can coexist with avoiding global blame; do not replace practical clarification with soothing words alone.

OA | Older adults

A supportive action may replace a phrase. Do not demand a change in speech style or spiritual meaning that does not suit the person.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose one response for a suitable opportunity. There is no required memorization or repetition until calm; practicing only in conversation and deciding words are unhelpful are options.

At the next session

Check whether the response reduces humiliation and leaves room to act with dignity. Do not measure success by belief in the phrase or disappearance of the feeling.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/tips-and-support/raise-low-self-esteem/
www.nhs.uk/every-mind-matters/lifes-challenges/maintaining-healthy-relationships-and-mental-wellbeing/

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